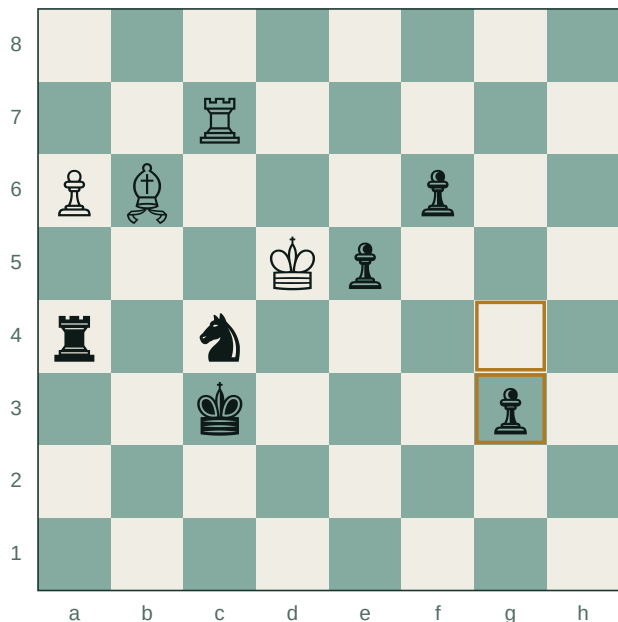


Promotion combinations: White, move 51

Promotion combinations

White to move



Previous move: 50...g3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

51. a7 Kb3 52. Rxc4 Rxc4 53. a8=Q

51.a7 The pawn moves from a6 to a7. Recorded reply: **51...Kb3**.

52.Rxc4 The rook captures the knight on c4. Recorded reply: **52...Rxc4**.

53.a8=Q The pawn moves from a7 to a8. The pawn becomes a queen.

At the end, nominal material is White 12 / Black 8 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +6. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +6: the balance goes from -2 to +4. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Always inspect stalemate and underpromotion resources. A queen is usually strongest, but the exact position determines the choice.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

An advanced pawn can turn a tactical sequence into a new queen or another useful piece. Promotion may occur with capture or check, and the choice of piece can change the outcome.

HOW TO LOOK

Calculate the pawn's route, the safety of the promotion square, and whether the new piece can survive or give a decisive check.

The defending king is on c3. Absolute pin: knight on c4.